

JJ Wetherholt

23.5 years old
PPI Pick Eligible

#26
Bats: Left
Throws: Right

G	AVG/OBP/SLG	HR	RBI	SB	BsR	wRC+	DRS	fWAR
130	.242/.343/.370	17	48	14	3.4	104	12	4.4

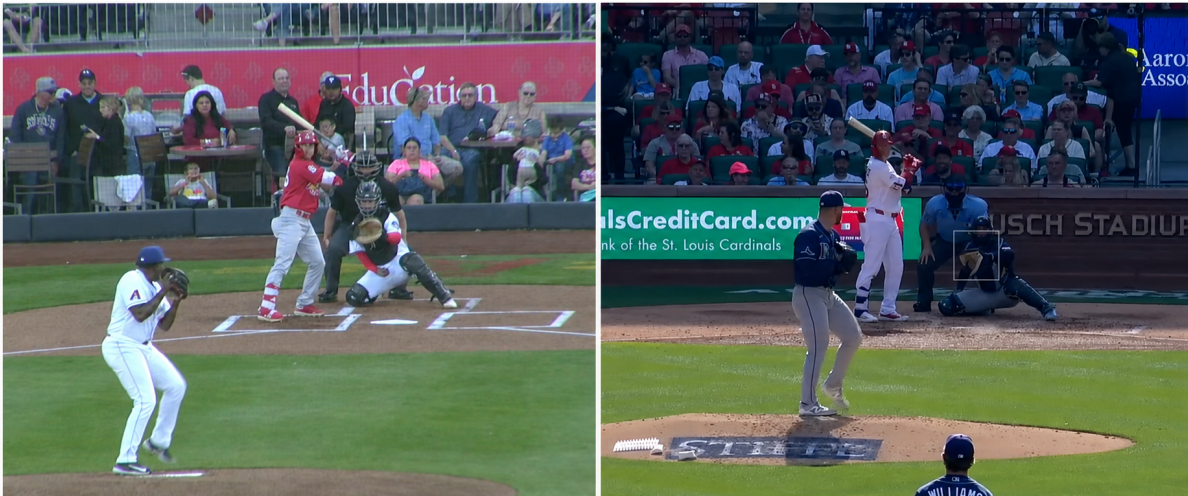
SECOND-HALF DECLINE

JJ Wetherholt is currently leading the NL rookies in fWAR due to his strong offensive value at 2B and outstanding defensive ability. Wetherholt did not face a May slump but has instead fallen off more in July and August. From March to June, Wetherholt slashed .261/.358/.405, producing a 116 wRC+ with a .349 xwOBA, adding 12 home runs while playing Gold Glove defense at second base. Since the start of July, Wetherholt has slashed to .211/.320/.317 and slumped to an 85 wRC+.

QUIET, SOUND MECHANICS AND ADVANCED ZONE CONTROL

2025

2026



Wetherholt's 2025 MiLB stance and 2026 Opening Day stance

The biggest change in Wetherholt's stance came this offseason. Wetherholt is more upright at the plate with a less rigid base, mainly due to narrowing his feet. His hands are lower and closer to his body, with a slight bat movement as he waits for the pitcher to set. These combinations could suggest Wetherholt is looking to be more fluid and loose in his swing, finding more rhythm and staying relaxed. The relaxed nature of his pre-pitch setup allows his fluid swing and clean mechanics to build off each other, making a continuous natural swing very evident for the 2024 first-round pick.

FATIGUE, WRIST TENDONITIS AND FALLING BAT SPEED

The biggest change in Wetherholt's data is that his swing appears to tire over the course of the season. In the next 48 games, Wetherholt's max velo has dropped to 105.5 mph, while his average launch angle has significantly decreased to 8.4 degrees. Wetherholt's Fast-Swing% has also fallen from 22.8% to 14.5%. Combine this with a shift in his attack direction from -4 degrees to -10 degrees, meaning his barrel could be slowing a bit more in the zone and traveling more toward the opposite field at contact. This could imply that the direction of Wetherholt's barrel is lagging as a result of his falling bat speed.

At this point, we do not yet know how much of Wetherholt's second-half decline was due to normal rookie fatigue, the wrist injury, or a more exploitable offensive weakness. A larger healthy sample should help distinguish between those factors, making his offensive response one of the more interesting developments to monitor in 2027. Wetherholt has already established himself as one of the most impactful defensive second basemen in baseball during his rookie season, with the major defensive value and range metrics supporting his case. With 12 DRS and 22 OAA, few second basemen cover as much ground as Wetherholt.